



Tredegar Iron Works

One of the largest foundries in America, Tredegar was a key asset for the Confederacy. It is believed to have produced about half of the artillery pieces manufactured for the South during the war.

The gulf widens

Over the course of the war, the Union gained strength as its supply systems became more efficient and it began to incorporate technological innovations, such as the repeating rifle. In contrast, the Confederacy's supply situation worsened as it lost territory and its population became further exhausted. An increasingly effective Union naval blockade put an end to coastal shipping, which placed even more pressure on the South's overstretched ground transportation. The blockade also prevented the Confederacy from importing material from Europe. Not being able to buy equipment from abroad also affected the railroad network, because repairs required machinery that the Confederacy did not possess.

Yet, despite the growing industrial inequality between the two sides, in the final analysis the Confederacy lost the war because of its inability to defeat Union armies on the battlefield. Poorly equipped though the Confederate soldier was in comparison to his Union counterpart, he usually had enough arms and equipment to